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Discussion: Killing Us Softly

After watching Jean Kilbourne's film "Killing Us Softly 4", my first impression is the film's use of advertising to push unrealistic standards to women. Many ads included include women sexually posed or cropped so only specific body parts are showing. This pushes unrealistic beauty standards and the objectification of women in the film. The film aims to inform the consumer on the destructive culture of modern-day advertising. The purpose of the film is to show people how the repeated objectification of women can change the way the public thinks about women, whether they know it or not. The exigence of Kilbourne's research is the pattern she noticed in advert Kilbourne, Jean. *Killing Us Softly 4* isements she was seeing in the real world that sexualized and objectified women. She saw this as a cultural message that this was how women were "supposed" to look. Kilbourne utilizes ethos within the film by establishing her credibility as a researcher. Her credibility is built by her decades of advertisement analysis. She uses logos by showing the pattern of women looking thinner and younger in multiple compared advertisements. Her claim is that this places women in a damaging place in modern culture. She uses pathos in the film through the use of disturbing ads that are meant to catch the viewer's attention and leave a lasting impression. Some examples include ads that picture women in vulnerable positions.

Works Cited

Kilbourne, Jean. *Killing Us Softly 4*